

- Think about your exit options before you buy a house. There are three main ways your future self can deal with a property: just keep living in it, turn it into a rental, or sell it for a profit. The more exit options you have, the better. If you're able to find a house that is pleasant to live in, holds its own as a future rental, and has a high chance of short-term appreciation, you've basically won the homeowner lottery.
- Appreciation is a scary variable (scearable?), especially in the short term. The national average works when looking twenty or thirty years into the future, but massive fluctuations can happen between now and then. If you want to be able to count on selling your home for a profit in five or so years, it's best to take a different approach.

3 PK, "Historical Home Prices: Monthly Median Value in the US from 1953-2020," DQYDJ, September 5, 2020, <https://dqydj.com/historical-home-prices/>.